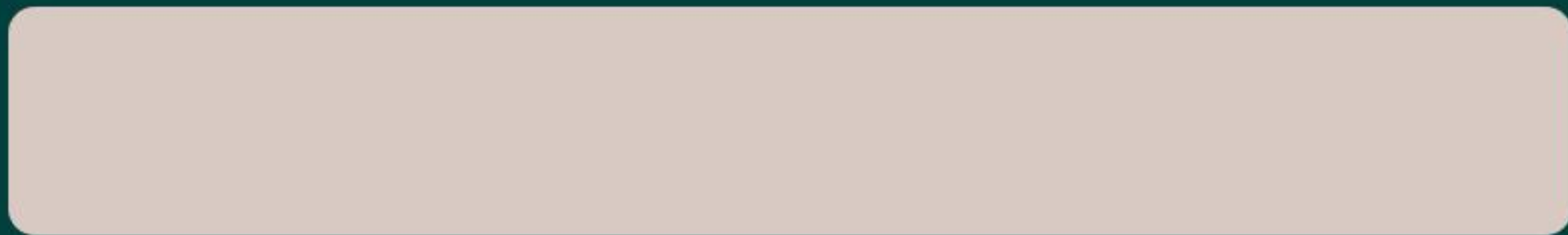


By 2030, the world's data centres could use *more electricity than Japan* does today.

Japan's electricity use today



Global data centres, 2030 (projected) · ~945 TWh



Source: IEA, *Energy and AI* (2025), base case.

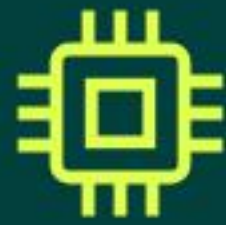
SWIPE →

Wait, what is a *data centre*?

A building packed with computers called **servers**. They store, process and deliver the data behind banking, streaming, cloud apps and AI, every second of every day.



Store



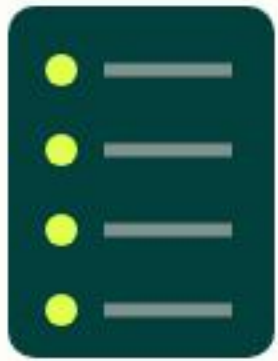
Process



Deliver

The "cloud" is not in the sky. It's thousands of these buildings, switched on 24×7.

Two things never *switch off.*



01

The servers

Running day and night, they turn almost all the electricity they use into heat.



02

The cooling

Fans, chillers and pumps work non-stop to stop that heat from damaging the servers.

More data means more servers, more heat and more power.

Demand is set to *more than double.*



In 2024, data centres used about **1.5% of the world's electricity**. That's on track for **more than 2×** by 2030.

Source: IEA, *Energy and AI* (2025): global data centre electricity consumption, base case.

The biggest driver? *Artificial intelligence.*

The IEA names AI as the most important driver of data centre electricity growth to 2030, alongside the rise of other digital services.

01

Training large AI models

02

Answering billions of AI queries

03

Cloud apps for every business

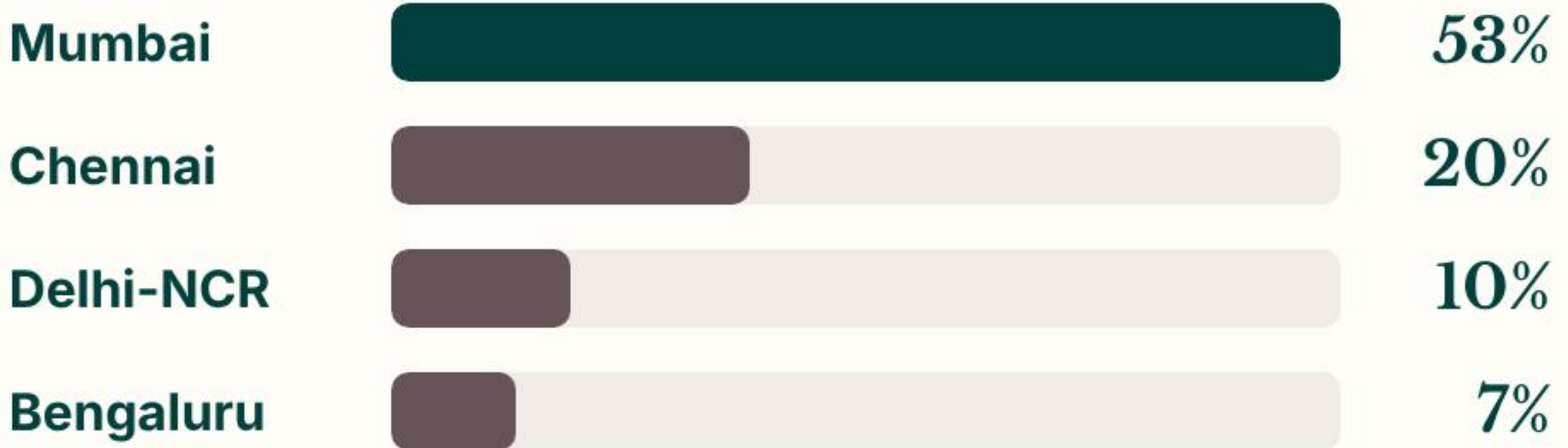
04

Streaming and digital payments

Source: IEA, *Energy and AI* (2025), executive summary.

India's data centres draw about **1.5 GW**.

Mumbai hosts roughly half. Chennai, Delhi-NCR and Bengaluru follow.



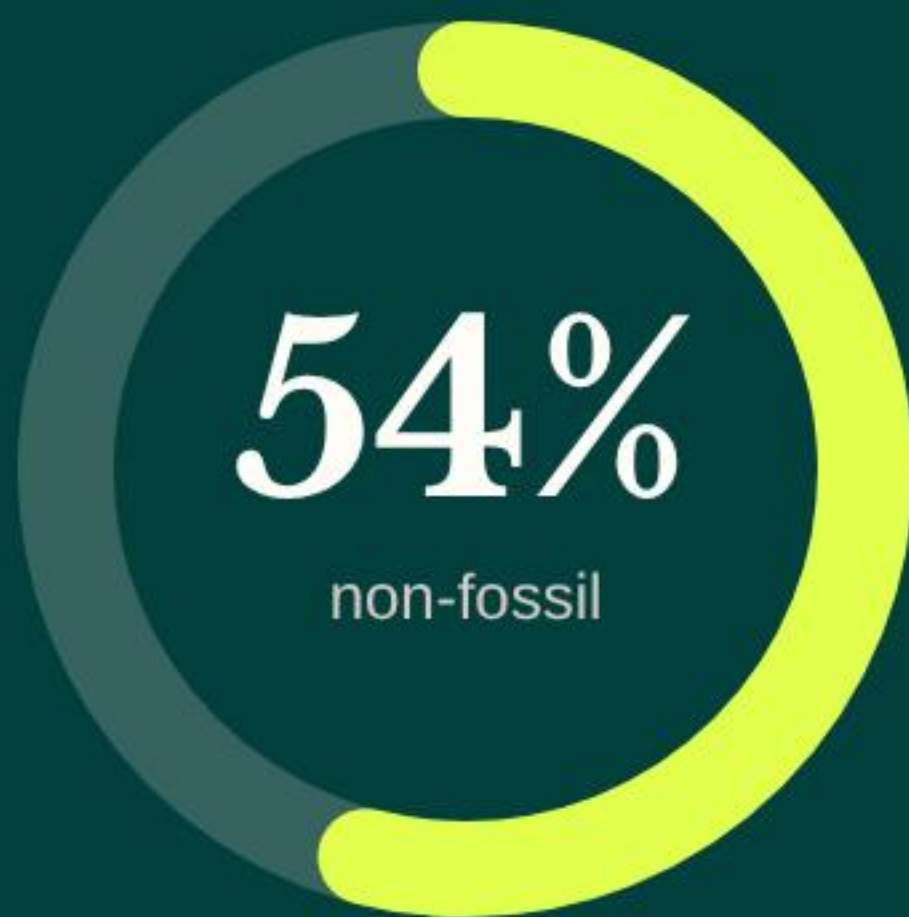
1.5 GW → 4.5 GW+

2025 → 2030
(top seven cities)

Sources: MeitY (2025 capacity); CBRE (share of operational capacity, Sept 2025); Colliers (2025 projection).

— THE HOPEFUL PART

India's grid is *getting cleaner, fast.*



More than half of India's installed power capacity is now **non-fossil**.

300 GW+ installed, over 60% of the 500 GW goal for 2030.

Honest note: installed capacity isn't the same as generation, and coal still supplies most of India's electricity. But every new clean gigawatt makes the cloud cleaner too.

Source: MNRE, non-fossil installed capacity as of 31 July 2026 (300.5 GW).

Three levers for a *greener cloud.*



Clean power

Solar, wind and long-term clean energy contracts



Efficient cooling

Less energy wasted keeping servers cool



Water-wise design

Recycled water and low-water cooling systems

— THE TAKEAWAY

The internet has a power bill.

India can choose how it's paid.

NEXT IN THIS SERIES

Why is India building so many data centres?

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